

Citadel Journal Issue 9

NECROMANTIC MAGIC

Magic for Undead Fleets



MAN O' WAR

NECROMANTIC MAGIC

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This article is especially for all gamers suffering from Man O' War withdrawal symptoms and who need more rules to keep them from writing angry letters to us. Here we are following up on the Undead fleet rules printed in issue 6. I have taken a look at the Necromantic magic used by the Liches and Necromancers and devised many cunning spells to accompany them. Only one person has sent pictures of an Undead fleet to us and we know that some people have ordered the parts for an Undead fleet from mail order so come on, get modelling.

When the dark winds blow and the storm beats strong, dark tales are told of creatures and spooks. Eerie tales that tell of the dead walking and gathering, a gathering of the minions of night. Such creatures are only spoken of in whispers and rumour, in many places they are just a legend, but they exist and on land and sea they crawl and sail to bring death and destruction to all who are not Undead.

Under black skies that flash with unseen lightning and swooping bats, the dead go to sea in vast Floating Necropolises, Ghostships doomed to traverse the seven seas

for time eternal and Skullships which carry the Skeletons, Zombies and Wights which form the ranks of the dead.

When the damned gather for battle they are brought together by a powerful magic user who uses his magic to bind them all to his will. This is usually a Liche but Necromancers also use the powers of the dead to bring death and destruction to all enemies. As the minions of the dead march forward lightning sparks over the skies and balls of fire light up the battle with their spectral brilliance. Necromantic spells from the dawn of time bring havoc and death to the living.

LICHES AND NECROMANCERS

An Undead fleet is commanded by a Liche or a Necromancer. They are also the Wizard and as such are the most important part of any Undead fleet. The spells and rules override those printed in Citadel Journal 6 for the Undead magic. The rules for the ships are still the same as stated in CJ 6. If you have a Tomb King as Admiral then you must have a wizard as instructed by the Journal. He may not use Necromantic magic but must use the normal magic deck that comes with the Man O' War game.

A Necromancer or Liche takes all 12 Necromantic magic cards at the beginning of the game and may cast one per magic phase, and dispel once per magic phase as well. Unlike other Wizards though, after he has cast the spell he rolls a D6. On a 1 - 2 he must discard the spell as normal, but on a 3 - 5 he can choose to discard a spell card that he did not cast this turn instead of the one he did. If he rolls a 6 the power of the grave means that he does not discard a spell at all. This roll is NOT made if the spell was dispelled or for any cards used to dispel. You must automatically discard the spell card.

A Necromancer or Liche may not gain Necromantic cards back during the End Phase but must wait until all of the Necromantic deck has been used before getting all of the cards back again.

Dispels

Necromantic magic is very hard to dispel and as such a Wizard can only dispel using a spell of his own college of magic.



Skaven Grey Seers and Chaos sorcerers are of equal power and as such may dispel as normal. Liches and Necromancers can dispel any kind of magic (even Skaven or Chaos), but two cards must be discarded and a roll is made against the lowest casting roll. If you are using the High Magic or Waaagh Magic rules printed in Citadel Journals 2 and 5 respectively then they will use the dispel rules in exactly the same way as stated in those Journals.

Boarding Actions

During a boarding action when an enemy crew counter is killed put them to one side for now. When the boarding action is complete roll a D6 for every crew counter which was killed. On a roll of 5+ the Liche or Necromancer has brought them back from the grave to fight in the ranks of the Undead against their former friends and shipmates. Place a Skeleton crew counter onboard the ship that was boarding. It will not work if the ship lost the boarding action or if the Liche or Necromancer dies or is captured. The amount of crew cannot exceed the limit that the ship has on its crew. Any extra are wasted.

Losing your Liche or Necromancer

If a Liche or Necromancer dies or is captured during the battle then the magic that binds the Undead together is lost and all Undead Ships of the Line take D6 below the waterline hits with no save possible at all. Battle Honours are awarded as usual.

Special Actions

The special Actions rules printed in Citadel Journal 6 are now rendered obsolete by these spell rules. So if you are using the spells printed here you may not use the special actions. You may however, use the special action rules if you take a Tomb King as your Admiral because this balances out the fact that a Tomb King cannot use Necromantic Magic.

Points Cost

The table below shows the points cost for Liches and Necromancers together with all the other information you need to know to use them. Note that the crew pts / 500 points have been changed because it has been found that more are needed for a reasonably crewed fleet. The points cost for a Tomb king has been included here because its crew pts/500 points has been altered.

Points Cost Table				
	Casting/ Dispel	Points Cost	Battle Honours	Crew Pts per 500 points
Liche	+1	300	12	15
Necro.	None	200	10	12
Tomb King	None	50	7	10



UNDEAD IN CAMPAIGNS

As a campaign progress' Undead will become more powerful and the Liche or Necromancer will be able to raise up more Undead. After every battle roll D6 and add 2 to get a number between 3 and 8. This is the amount of extra points that can be added to the Liche or Necromancers crewpts/500 points. Crew are chosen again at the beginning of each battle so any that were killed can be bought back and this time you can have more crew to harass your opponent with. Any Skeletons which join your fleet from either a spell or killing an opponents crew are lost because the magic that sustained them has drained away.

HINTS AND TIPS

As you can see from the above rules it is important to keep your Liche or Necromancer safe during the battle because if anything happens to him its more than likely you have lost the game. Protect the Floating Necropolis as much as you can but do remember it is a match for the Black Ark of Naggaroth so do not be too timid with it.

An Undead fleets biggest advantage is the huge amount of crew it can have so remember to get into boarding actions as soon as you can. When you are boarding remember to roll for each crew counter you kill because they can add to your crew and make them almost unstoppable.

Undead are also very good in campaigns and get more and more crew as they go along. A good tip to remember about Undead crew is to take one Wight for each ship to lead in the boarding actions and then use up the rest of your crew points on Zombies because you will get the biggest bonus in boarding this way.

Until next time, keep on gaming.

NECROMANTIC SPELL

Spirit Wraith

Casting:4+

In a shower of magic a Spirit Wraith appears and screams across the sky towards the enemy. The Wraith drops on to the deck of the ship, picks up some crew and departs again to the world of night.

Cast on: Any enemy ship.

Effects: The Spirit Wraith carries away 1 crew from an enemy ship.

NECROMANTIC SPELL

Legion Of The Damned

Casting:6+

A dark wind rises behind the Undead fleet and riding upon the wind are the legion of the damned who land upon the deck of an Undead ship.

Cast on: Any single friendly ship.

Effects: The crew on a ship of your choice are doubled this turn only. Next turn they will be back to the normal amount.

NECROMANTIC SPELL

Death Bolt

Casting:4+

The wizard swallows some ground bone powder and spits it out suffusing it with dark power. The bone solidifies into a Death Bolt which strikes a ship close by.

Cast on: Any single enemy ship within 18" of the Necromancer.

Effects: The Death Bolt inflicts 3 random hits to low locations with a -1 saving throw modifier.

NECROMANTIC SPELL

Plague of Skulls

Casting:4+

The Necromancer picks a skull out of a big black bag and hurls it at an enemy ship. The magic power makes the skull multiply a hundred times into lots of skulls which suddenly take on life and fall on the enemies crew biting them as they fall.

Cast on: Any single enemy ship.

Effects: The ship may not move or fire this turn and also on a D6 roll of 4 or more they will lose one crew counter to the biting skulls.

NECROMANTIC SPELL

Vanhel's Danse Macabre

Casting:4+

The power of the grave screams across the sea and strikes every Undead ship which imbues the crew with the invigorating power of chaos. The strength of this magic drives them into a macabre dance of destruction.

Cast on: The whole Undead fleet.

Effects: All Undead ships may move an extra 2" this turn.

NECROMANTIC SPELL

Rite of Summoning

Casting:3+

Twisting tendrils of black smoke swirl around the bodies of the fallen and restore them to life.

Cast on: Any friendly ship which has lost crew.

Effects: Roll a D6 for the ship that had lost crew and see what is summoned in their place.

- | | |
|-----|-------------|
| 1-2 | 3 Zombies |
| 3-4 | 2 Skeletons |
| 5-6 | 1 Wight |

NECROMANTIC SPELL

Davy Jones' Locker

Casting:5+

The Necromancer stretches his senses to a nearby shipwreck and touches each man who died there. The Skeletons rise up from the deep and attack an enemy vessel.

Cast on: Any enemy ship.

Effects: Fight a boarding action immediately, you will have 2 Skeletons and no grapeshot is allowed. After the boarding action is finished the magic sustaining the skeletons is lost and they fall back into the sea. This is a fight to the death with no escape for either side.

NECROMANTIC SPELL

Raise the Lost

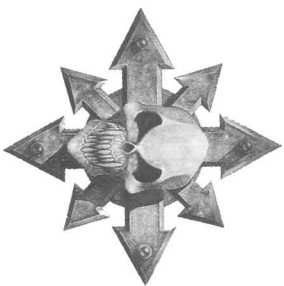
Casting:5+

The Necromancer fires black beams of magic from his hands into the sea and brings a sunken ship to the surface for a short time only.

Cast on: Any ship thats sunk, provided the wreck counter is still there.

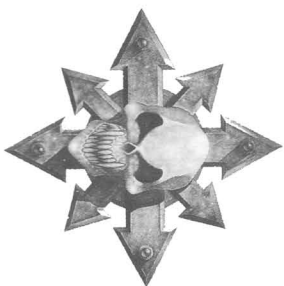
Effects: Bring the ship on up to 3" from the wreck counter. It may move and fire, board if it can, under your control. The ship sinks again during the next End Phase, but do not place a counter for it. Any damage was repaired and any special bonus' the crew had are lost, they will count as 2 normal Skeletons counters.

NECROMANTIC



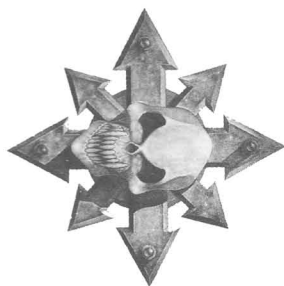
SPELL

NECROMANTIC



SPELL

NECROMANTIC



SPELL

HOW TO MAKE YOUR NECROMANTIC MAGIC DECK

or how else do I fill this space then?

Making your necromantic spell cards could not be easier if we made them for you. Simply photocopy these two pages, the one on the right you will need 4 copies of. Get some thin card and cut and stick the spells and the spellcard backs so that you have a splendid magic card. I have also included some curse of years counters for you, aren't I nice to you.

CURSE
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NECROMANTIC SPELL

Deathship

Casting:4+

Glowing tendrils of mist cover a friendly ship and produce an illusion around the ship which makes the ship even more frightening than it already is. The stench of death surrounds the ship and enemy sailors refuse to go near it.

Cast on: Any single friendly ship.

Effects: The ship may not be attacked in ANY way this turn.

NECROMANTIC SPELL

The Curse of Years

Casting:6+

The Necromancer calls upon the most powerful curse he knows and hurts it at an enemy ship. The ships crew are aged and die due to this hideous curse.

Cast on: Any single enemy ship.

Effects: Roll a D6 for each crew member on the ship. On a 5-6 the crew are aged and die. If there are any crew left alive place a Curse of Years counter beside it. In the next magic phase roll again, this time the crew will be aged on a 4-6. If they are still alive subtract -1 to the roll every magic phase down to a maximum of 2-6. This spell may be dispelled in subsequent turns by an opposing magic user. This is done in the same way as it would normally be done (See main text).

NECROMANTIC SPELL

Leg Bone Connected to the Knee Bone

Casting:4+

The Necromancer reaches out and knits the two damaged bones together to heal a ship of some damage it has suffered. The damaged area works as if new.

Cast on: Any friendly ship which has damaged locations.

Effects: Completely repairs two locations which have been damaged.

NECROMANTIC SPELL

Horde of the Grave

Casting:6+

The Necromancer utters an age old incantation and proceeds to summon the horde of the grave. The horde will arrive chittering and desperate to get into action.

Cast on: Any single friendly ship.

Effects: You may add D6 + 2 Skeletons to any ship in your fleet provided it does not take them over the crew limit of the ship. Any crew which cannot fit on a ship are lost in the void.